

Lab 2 — second-site Supervisor deployment

Instantiates the root module for the second lab: **different vCenter, isolated network**, with the subnets swapped relative to lab 1:

Network	Port group	CIDR
Workload	VM Network	192.168.1.0/24
Management	outer-mgmt-net	192.168.2.0/24

Nested ESXi hosts already running at `192.168.1.241-243`. This example has its **own Terraform state** — nothing here touches lab 1 (`examples/lab`), and generated artifacts (TLS cert/key, enable spec) land in `examples/lab2/generated/`, separate from lab 1's.

1. Values you MUST update (search `CHANGE-ME` in `main.tf`)

Variable	What to set it to
<code>vcenter_server</code>	FQDN of the lab-2 vCenter. Must resolve to the vCSA's IP from this machine — verify with <code>dsca cheutil -q host -a name <fqdn></code> (macOS), not just <code>dig</code>
<code>datacenter</code>	Datacenter name in the lab-2 vCenter (default <code>Datcenter</code>)
<code>physical_host_name</code>	The physical host's inventory name in vCenter — typically its IP
<code>physical_host_cluster</code>	Cluster containing the physical host (default <code>Cluster</code>)
<code>supervisor_cluster</code>	Cluster containing the three nested hosts (default <code>Supervisor-Cluster</code>)
<code>outer_datastore</code>	Datastore on the physical host where the HAProxy + NFS VMs deploy (default <code>datastore1</code>)
<code>management_gateway</code> / <code>management_dns</code>	Router + DNS reachable from <code>192.168.2.0/24</code> at this site

Variable	What to set it to
<code>workload_gateway</code> / <code>workload_dns</code>	Router + DNS reachable from <code>192.168.1.0/24</code> at this site

Verify-but-probably-keep (defaults follow the lab-1 conventions):

Variable	Default	Check
<code>nested_esxi_hosts</code>	<code>192.168.1.241-243</code>	must equal the hosts' vCenter inventory names exactly
<code>management_cp_starting_ip</code>	<code>192.168.2.231</code>	5 consecutive IPs free?
<code>nested_host_mgmt_ips</code> (in the module block)	<code>.1.24x → .2.24x</code>	mgmt IPs free? keys match <code>nested_esxi_hosts</code> ?
<code>workload_ip_range</code>	<code>192.168.1.201-230</code>	outside DHCP, doesn't overlap the router/hosts/VMs
<code>vip_pool</code> / <code>vip_pool_usable</code>	<code>192.168.1.248/29 → .249- .254</code>	free, outside DHCP
<code>nfs_ip</code> / <code>haproxy_ip</code> (module block / variable)	<code>.1.244</code> / <code>.1.245</code>	free
<code>ntp_servers</code> (module block)	<code>162.159.200.1</code>	reachable on UDP 123 from the physical host

Secrets go in `secrets.auto.tfvars` (never committed — see step 3).

2. Prerequisites before `terraform apply`

On the nested ESXi hosts (do this **FIRST**):



Set a unique hostname on each host. ESXi defaults to `localhost`; with that, every spherelet receives the same client-cert identity (`system:node:localhost`) and Kubernetes blocks node registration — the cluster comes up with zero worker nodes. See `TROUBLESHOOTING.md` → “Supervisor ESXi nodes never join”.

```
# on each host (SSH or DCUI), incrementing the name:
esxcli system hostname set --host=nested-esxi-1 --domain=<lab2-domain>
```

If spherelet ever ran on them while named `localhost`, also clear `/etc/vmware/spherelet/*.crt|*.key|*.pem` and restart spherelet after enable (full recipe in TROUBLESHOOTING.md).

☐

Each host has **three vNICs**: vmnic0 + vmnic1 on the outer `VM Network`, vmnic2 on the outer `outer-mgmt-net` path. ESXi does not detect hot-added NICs — power-cycle after adding.

☐

All three hosts joined to the Supervisor cluster and `connected`.

☐

Cluster vLCM image matches the installed ESXi build (vSphere UI → Cluster → Updates → Image → “All hosts compliant”). Mismatch fails Supervisor enable with VIB download errors.

In the lab-2 vCenter:

☐

Datacenter, both clusters, physical host, and datastore exist under the names configured above.

☐

Port groups `VM Network` and `outer-mgmt-net` exist on the physical host (Terraform sets their security flags — you don’t need to).

☐

SSO admin credentials for the account in `secrets.auto.tfvars`.

Network / environment:

☐

Routing between `192.168.1.0/24` and `192.168.2.0/24` (the Supervisor enable validates cross-subnet DNS from the CP VM).

☐

All static IPs in §1 are outside any DHCP scope.

☐

WAN egress from the workload subnet — the Ubuntu cloud OVA and the HAProxy Dataplane API binary download at deploy time.

☐

`vcenter_server` resolves correctly from this machine **and** will resolve correctly from the CP VMs (via `management_dns`). A public CNAME on the vCenter name will poison both — see `TROUBLESHOOTING.md` → DNS resolution.



Clocks sane on the physical host and vCSA (Terraform enables NTP on the physical host, but a wildly wrong vCSA clock still breaks TLS).

On this machine (once per workstation):



`make -C ../.. install-deps` — terraform, govc, python3+pyvmomi, curl, jq, openssl.

3. Commands to run (in order)

All paths relative to the repo root (`~/Repos/vcf9-supervisor-terraform`); the example lives in `examples/lab2/`.

How to SSH into an ESXi host (step 0 needs this)

Account: always the user `root`, with the ESXi **root password chosen when the host was installed** (this is a per-host password — not a vCenter/SSO login, and not the `secrets.auto.tfvars` passwords).

SSH is disabled by default on ESXi. Enable it first, any one of these ways:

- **vSphere Client:** select the host → Configure → System → Services → SSH → Start.
- **ESXi Host Client:** browse to `https://<host-ip>/ui`, log in as root → Manage → Services → `TSM-SSH` → Start.
- **DCUI** (the yellow console screen on the VM): F2 → log in → Troubleshooting Options → Enable SSH.
- **govc** (from this machine, pointed at the lab-2 vCenter): `GOVC_HOST=/
<datacenter>/host/<cluster>/<host-ip> govc host.service start TSM-SSH`

Running a command over SSH — either interactively:

```
ssh root@192.168.1.241      # type the root password when prompted
esxcli system hostname get  # you're now in the ESXi shell
exit
```

or one-shot without opening a shell (this is the form the commands below use — everything inside the quotes runs on the host):

```
ssh root@192.168.1.241 'esxcli system hostname get'
```

When done, stop SSH again from the same menu (or `govc host.service stop TSM-SSH`) — leaving it on triggers a persistent yellow warning on the host and is poor hygiene.

```
# 0. FIRST: verify each nested host has a unique hostname — ESXi
#   installs default to "localhost", which silently breaks spherelet
#   node registration (§2 / TROUBLESHOOTING.md). The helper script
#   checks and only sets when needed (idempotent, safe to re-run):
cd ~/Repos/vcf9-supervisor-terraform
SSHPASS='<esxi root password>' ./scripts/sv-set-hostnames -d <lab2-domain> \
  192.168.1.241=nested-esxi-1 \
  192.168.1.242=nested-esxi-2 \
  192.168.1.243=nested-esxi-3
#   (Omit SSHPASS to be prompted per host. If SSH is disabled on a
#   host, enable it via govc against the lab-2 vCenter first:
#   GOVC_HOST=/<datacenter>/host/<supervisor-cluster>/<host-ip> \
#   govc host.service start TSM-SSH
#   — or use the DCUI/host client. Equivalent manual command:
#   ssh root@<host> 'esxcli system hostname set --host=<name> --
#     domain=<domain>')
```

```
cd ~/Repos/vcf9-supervisor-terraform/examples/lab2
```

```
# 1. Secrets file (gitignored) — copy the template and fill in:
cp secrets.auto.tfvars.example secrets.auto.tfvars
vi secrets.auto.tfvars          # vcenter_password, haproxy_password, vcenter_ip
chmod 600 secrets.auto.tfvars
```

```
# 2. Fill in the CHANGE-ME values:
vi main.tf
```

```
# 3. Initialize providers (first run only):
terraform init
```

```
# 4. Sanity-check the config:
terraform validate
```

```
# 5. Preview — expect ~20+ resources to create, 0 to destroy:
terraform plan
```

```
# 6. Apply (~25-30 min unattended; the Supervisor-enable step polls
#   up to 45 min at the end):
terraform apply
```

```
# 7. Post-apply outputs (kubectl login instructions, API VIP):
terraform output next_steps
```

Or drive it through the Makefile from the repo root:

```
cd ~/Repos/vcf9-supervisor-terraform
make TF_DIR=examples/lab2 init
make TF_DIR=examples/lab2 plan
make TF_DIR=examples/lab2 apply
```

(Note: `make hard-check` and the `scripts/sv-*` helpers are hardwired to lab 1's IPs/vCenter — don't use them against this site without editing.)

Teardown: `terraform destroy` from `examples/lab2/` — disables the Supervisor cleanly first (10–15 min), then removes the VMs, DVS, and policy.

4. After apply — verify

```
# All 4-6 nodes Ready (3 CP + your 3 ESXi agents). CP root password:
# ssh to the lab-2 vCSA → shell → /usr/lib/vmware-wcp/decryptK8Pwd.py
ssh root@<cp-floating-ip> 'kubectl get nodes'

# API reachable through the HAProxy VIP:
curl -sk --max-time 5 "$(cd examples/lab2 && terraform output -raw
    supervisor_api_vip)/version"
```

If the ESXi agent nodes are missing, work through `TROUBLESHOOTING.md` → “Supervisor ESXi nodes never join” — check the spherelet cert identity (hostname issue) first, then the vmk path.